

Post Study Work Visa

Apply for this visa if you want to work in New Zealand soon after you have completed your studies here. It allows you to stay and work in New Zealand for up to 3 years, depending on what you studied.

Apply online (<https://online.immigration.govt.nz/>)

Length of stay

Up to

3 years

Cost

From

NZD \$1670

Processing time

80% within

4.5 weeks

Residence option

Can lead to a resident visa

Yes

To apply you must:

have recently finished studying in New Zealand for an approved qualification
apply no later than 3, 6 or 12 months after your student visa expires, depending on what you studied and what visa you had
have at least NZD \$5,000 to pay your living expenses
meet the other requirements of this visa.

This visa lets you:

stay and work in New Zealand for up to 3 years depending on your study
work for any employer in any job if you have a degree level 7 or higher qualification
work for an employer in a job that meets our requirements if you have a non-degree level 7 or lower qualification
support visas for your partner and dependent children — your partner can apply for a work visa and your children can apply for student visas to study as [domestic students](#) in New Zealand.

[Bringing family if you have a work visa](#)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/bringing-family-to-new-zealand/bringing-family-if-you-have-a-work-visa/>)

You can only have this visa once.

Note

From late 2026, Post Study Work Visa eligibility will be extended to applicants who have:

- an NZQCF level 7 Graduate Diploma that they studied full-time for in New Zealand, and
- a bachelor's degree that they completed in New Zealand or overseas.

See the announcement for more information.

[New and updated post-study work visa options](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/about-us/news-centre/new-and-updated-post-study-work-visa-options/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/about-us/news-centre/new-and-updated-post-study-work-visa-options/>)

On this page

Apply online (<https://online.immigration.govt.nz/>)

How long you can stay

You can stay and work in New Zealand for up to 3 years depending on the level of your qualification and how long you spent studying for it.

[Staying to work after finishing your study](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/after-you-finish-your-study/staying-to-work-after-finishing-your-study/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/study/after-you-finish-your-study/staying-to-work-after-finishing-your-study/>)

Who can apply

To apply for this visa, you must have recently finished studying in New Zealand and have:

- a degree level 7 or higher qualification — level 8 Postgraduate Diploma, level 9 Masters degree or level 10 Doctoral degree
- a non-degree level 7 or lower qualification that is on the list of qualifications eligible for a Post Study Work Visa — you must intend to work in a job that is related to what you studied, and apply in time
- be in good health
- have a good character
- have a genuine reason for coming to New Zealand
- have enough money to pay your expenses.

Qualifications needed for a Post Study Work Visa

New Zealand qualification

You must have gained a qualification in New Zealand that lets you apply for this visa.

You must provide:

- a copy of your qualification
- your academic transcript, or
- a letter from your tertiary education provider confirming you have completed your qualification.

If you have studied a degree level 7 or higher qualification, you must have studied it full-time for at least 30 weeks in New Zealand.

If you have studied a non-degree level 7 or lower qualification, it must be on the list of qualifications eligible for a Post Study Work Visa. Your study must have been full-time in New Zealand, and for the full duration required to gain the qualification. The job you end up taking must be related to what you studied. This will be specified in your visa conditions.

If you immediately follow your first qualification with a higher-level qualification that you studied towards for less than 30 weeks, which does not meet the requirements for a Post Study Work Visa (PSWV), you can apply for a PSWV based on your first qualification.

Qualifications needed for a Post Study Work Visa

When to apply

You must apply for a Post Study Work Visa (PSWV) no later than 3 months after your student visa expires, or within 3 months of the end date of your student visa for a second qualification (if you completed a bachelor's degree immediately followed by an honours or post-graduate diploma and held consecutive student visas for these qualifications), except if you completed:

- a Doctoral degree, you must apply for a PSWV no later than 6 months after your student visa expires
- an eligible qualification for a PSWV and then, immediately after, completed a higher-level qualification in less than 30 weeks, you can apply for a PSWV based on your first qualification no later than 12 months after your student visa for the first qualification expires.

For example, if you completed a Postgraduate Diploma (PGDip) that was full-time for at least 30 weeks, and then you enrolled straight away in a Master's degree and completed it in less than 30 weeks, you can apply for a PSWV based on your PGDip, your first qualification. You will have 12 months from the end date of your visa for the PGDip to apply.

We will check our records to make sure that you are applying in time.

Note

If you did not complete the qualification recorded on your student visa, we may not approve your Post Study Work Visa application.

Health

We may ask you to have a chest X-ray, a medical examination or both as proof of your good health.

When we process your application, we will let you know by email if we need you to have a chest X-ray or medical examination.

Why you may need to provide evidence you are in good health

[Update on medical certificate requests on Immigration Online](#)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/about-us/news-centre/update-on-medical-certificate-requests-on-immigration-online/>)

If you are staying less than:

- 6 months, you do not normally need a chest X-ray
- 12 months, you do not normally need a medical certificate.

Who needs an X-ray or medical examination

How to get an X-ray or medical examination

If staying for more than 6 months

If you will stay in New Zealand for more than 6 months, you must have a chest X-ray if you:

- are a citizen of a country that does not have a low incidence of tuberculosis (TB), or
- have spent more than 3 months in the last 5 years in a country that does not have a low incidence of TB.

You must provide a new chest X-ray certificate, even if you have provided one to us previously, if you:

- have spent 6 months in a row in a country that does not have a low incidence of TB since the date of your last X-ray certificate, and
- are now coming to New Zealand for more than 6 months — if you are in New Zealand this includes any time you have already spent here.

Countries with a low incidence of tuberculosis

Character

You may need to provide police certificates as proof of your good character.

If you have a criminal conviction or are a security risk to New Zealand we might not give you a visa.

Character requirements for New Zealand visas

You must provide police certificates that are less than 6 months old when you apply if:

- you are aged 17 or older, and
- your total time in New Zealand will be 24 months or longer. This includes time you spent in New Zealand in the past on other visas.

Police certificates must be from:

- countries you are a citizen of, and
- countries you have spent more than 5 years in since you turned 17.

You do not need to provide police certificates if you provided them with an earlier visa application, and they were issued in the last 24 months.

If we ask for a new police certificate when processing your application, you will need to send us a new one.

Police certificates

[How to get a police certificate](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/applying-for-a-visa/providing-evidence-and-documents-to-support-your-visa-application/good-character-requirements-and-police-certificates/get-a-police-certificate/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/applying-for-a-visa/providing-evidence-and-documents-to-support-your-visa-application/good-character-requirements-and-police-certificates/get-a-police-certificate/>)

Genuine intentions

When we decide if your intentions are genuine, we consider all the information that:

- you provide to support your application
- we have about your personal circumstances
- you have previously provided to us.

Genuine intentions to visit or work in New Zealand

Have enough money to live on

When you apply you must provide documents, such as bank statements in your name, that show you have at least NZD \$5,000 in total for your stay.

This applies to visa applications for 1, 2 or 3 years.

We may ask to see these documents when you arrive in New Zealand.

Documents you need

When you apply

When you apply, you need to provide:

- a copy of your passport or [certificate of identity](#) — if you apply on paper it must be a [certified copy](#)
- 1 acceptable photo if you apply online, or 2 photos if you apply on paper
- proof of the qualification you have gained in New Zealand
- police certificates, if required — include translated versions if they are not in English.

Providing your passport for online application

Visa and NZeTA photos

Note

Your passport or certificate of identity must be valid for at least 3 months after the date you plan to leave New Zealand.

Applicants applying from French Polynesia or Wallis and Futuna

If you are not a French national, also provide a copy of your carte d'assuré.

Applicants applying from New Caledonia

Also provide a copy of your livret de famille.

If you are not a French national, also provide a copy of your carte d'assuré.

Citizens of Indonesia

If you are a citizen of Indonesia, also provide your [Kartu Keluarga](#) .

Citizens of China applying from China, Hong Kong or Macao

You must also provide a completed supplementary form giving more details of your background and intentions.

[!\[\]\(5361750c22c4e047a52f4eac1ec2d4cc_img.jpg\)](#) Supplementary Form for Chinese visitors, workers and students (INZ 1027) - 补充表 - 适用于中国公民的访问, 学生及工作申请
(PDF, 338 KB) (<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/inz1027.pdf>)

You may also provide your Hukou household registration book as an additional form of identity.

Applicants from Hong Kong or Macao applying within China, Hong Kong or Macao

You may also provide your identity card as an additional form of identity.

If you are applying within China, Hong Kong or Macao, you must also provide a completed supplementary form if you are applying with a:

- passport from Hong Kong
- Hong Kong document of identity
- Hong Kong British National Overseas passport (HKBNO)
- passport from Macao

[!\[\]\(c694a3ff3b077d76910920a6a1593ab4_img.jpg\) Supplementary Form for Hong Kong and Macau visitors, workers and students \(INZ 1220\) 補充表 - 適用於香港及澳門居民的訪問、學生及工作申請](#)
(PDF, 240 KB) (<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/inz1220.pdf>)

After you apply

After you apply, we may contact you and ask for:

- evidence of a medical examination or chest X-ray
- police certificates as proof of your good character.

[Character requirements for New Zealand visas](#)

How to apply online

Follow these steps to complete your application online.

Note

To help prevent delays with processing, make sure your application contains all the required documents.

1 Successfully complete your qualification

When you have successfully completed your New Zealand qualification you can apply for a Post Study Work Visa.

You must apply for this visa:

- no later than 3 months after the end date of your student visa for your qualification
- within 3 months of the end date of your student visa for a second qualification — if you completed a bachelor's degree immediately followed by an honours or post-graduate diploma and held consecutive student visas for these qualifications
- no later than 6 months after the end date of your student visa if your qualification is a Doctoral degree, or
- within 12 months of the end date of your student visa for your first qualification — if you immediately completed a second, higher-level, qualification in less than 30 months.

If you studied towards a Doctoral degree, you can apply for a Post Study Work Visa after submitting your thesis.

We will check our records to make sure that you are applying in time.

You must remain on a valid visa at all times while you are in New Zealand.

Note

If you do not complete the qualification recorded on your student visa, we may not approve your Post Study Work Visa application.

2

Gather your documents

The section 'Who can apply' explains the requirements for this visa and what you will need as proof.

Our guide to applying can also help you.

[↓ Work Visa Guide \(INZ 1016\) - A guide for applying for a work visa \(PDF, 478 KB\)](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/Work-Visa-Guide-INZ-1016.pdf)
(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/Work-Visa-Guide-INZ-1016.pdf>)

Get documents translated

For your application, you must provide:

- certified English translations of police and medical certificates that are not in English
- copies of the original documents.

Note

Documents must be translated by someone who meets our requirements for providing English translations.

Providing English translations of supporting documents

Organise proof of identity and citizenship

If you need a new passport, allow yourself enough time to get it.

When you apply, make sure you enter your identity details exactly as they appear on your passport or certificate of identity.

Alert

If there are any mistakes in your identity details, your application may be delayed. We may also decline your application or refuse you entry to New Zealand.

Make sure your photos are acceptable for a New Zealand visa.

Visa and NZeTA photos

File formats for uploading documents and photographs

Book medical appointments, if required

After you apply online, we will contact you if we need you to organise a medical appointment. Your appointment should be for no earlier than 3 months before your arrival.

Apply for police certificates, if required

Check what you will need to include for a work visa.

Character requirements for New Zealand visas

When we process your application, we will contact you if we require police certificates from you.

Police certificates

Note

Your police certificates must be less than 6 months old when you submit your application. Allow yourself enough time to get these certificates.

Organise proof of your qualification

Get a copy of your qualification, or a letter or academic transcript from your tertiary education provider confirming you have completed your qualification.

Organise proof you have enough money to live on

Get recent bank statements in your name that show you have at least NZD \$5000.

3 **Submit your application and pay the fee**

To apply online, log in to your account, or set up an account if you do not have one already.

You can then fill in your application, upload your documents and pay the applicable fees.

Check the 'How to pay and submit' section for fees.

4 **Wait for our decision**

We will let you know if we need more information to process your application.

[Waiting for a visa](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/) (https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/)

[How long it takes to process an application](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/processing-a-visa-application/how-long-it-takes-to-process-an-application/)

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Check the 'How to pay and submit' section for timeframes.

Note

If you are already in New Zealand, you must have a valid visa. If your current temporary visa is going to expire while you are waiting for our decision, we will normally issue you an Interim Visa to let you stay in New Zealand lawfully.

[Interim Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/interim-visa/\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/interim-visa/)

5

Check your application status

Log in to your account to check the status of your application.

We will email you when we make a decision.

If we approve your application, we will give you an eVisa and email you a copy.

[Checking you visa application status](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/check-your-application-progress/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/check-your-application-progress/>)

[Using eVisas and visa labels](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/using-evisas-and-visa-labels/)

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Check the 'While you are in New Zealand' section to find out what you can and cannot do when you come to New Zealand.

How to apply on paper

Follow these steps to complete your application on paper.

Note

To help prevent delays with processing, make sure your application contains all the required documents.

1

Successfully complete your qualification

When you have successfully completed your New Zealand qualification you can apply for a Post Study Work Visa.

You must apply for this visa:

- no later than 3 months after the end date of your student visa for your qualification
- within 3 months of the end date of your student visa for a second qualification — if you completed a bachelor's degree immediately followed by an honours or post-graduate diploma and held consecutive student visas for these qualifications
- no later than 6 months after the end date of your student visa if your qualification is a Doctoral degree, or
- within 12 months of the end date of your student visa for your first qualification — if you immediately completed a second, higher-level, qualification in less than 30 months.

If you studied towards a Doctoral degree, you can apply for a Post Study Work Visa after submitting your thesis.

We will check our records to make sure that you are applying in time.

You must remain on a valid visa at all times while you are in New Zealand.

Note

If you do not complete the qualification recorded on your student visa, we may not approve your Post Study Work Visa application.

2

Gather your documents

The section 'Who can apply' explains the requirements for this visa and what you will need as proof.

Our guide to applying can also help you.

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(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/Work-Visa-Guide-INZ-1016.pdf>)

Get documents translated

For your application, you must provide:

- certified English translations of police and medical certificates that are not in English
- copies of the original documents.

Note

Documents must be translated by someone who meets our requirements for providing English translations.

Providing English translations of supporting documents

Organise proof of identity and citizenship

If you need a new passport, allow yourself enough time to get it.

When you apply, make sure you enter your identity details exactly as they appear on your passport or certificate of identity.

Alert

If there are any mistakes in your identity details, your application may be delayed. We may also decline your application or refuse you entry to New Zealand.

Make sure your photos are acceptable for a New Zealand visa.

Visa and NZeTA photos

Book medical appointments, if required

After you apply online, we will contact you if we need you to organise a medical appointment. Your appointment should be for no earlier than 3 months before your arrival.

Apply for police certificates, if required

Check what you will need to include for a work visa.

Character requirements for New Zealand visas

When we process your application, we will contact you if we require police certificates from you.

Police certificates

Note

Your police certificates must be less than 6 months old when you submit your application. Allow yourself enough time to get these certificates.

Organise proof of your qualification

Get a copy of your qualification, or a letter or academic transcript from your tertiary education provider confirming you have completed your qualification.

Organise proof you have enough money to live on

Get recent bank statements in your name that show you have at least NZD \$5000.

3 Complete the application form

Complete the application form and attach all supporting documents.

[!\[\]\(9dfdaff1d86ba3c1f8353b4d1b61b8c5_img.jpg\) Work Visa Guide \(INZ 1016\) - A guide for applying for a work visa \(PDF, 478 KB\)](#)
(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/Work-Visa-Guide-INZ-1016.pdf>)

[!\[\]\(83f22ed94ec5517769dd76d702c6bfd8_img.jpg\) Work Visa Application \(INZ 1015\) \(PDF, 576 KB\)](#)
(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/assets/inz/documents/forms-and-guides/Work-Visa-Application-INZ-1015.pdf>)

4 Submit your application and pay the fee

Check the 'How to pay and submit' section for fees and where to submit your application.

5 Wait for our decision

We will let you know if we need more information to process your application.

[Waiting for a visa](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/) (<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/>)

[How long it takes to process an application](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/processing-a-visa-application/how-long-it-takes-to-process-an-application/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/waiting-for-a-visa/processing-a-visa-application/how-long-it-takes-to-process-an-application/>)

Check the 'How to pay and submit' section for timeframes.

Note

If you are already in New Zealand, you must have a valid visa. If your current temporary visa is going to expire while you are waiting for our decision, we will normally issue you an Interim Visa to let you stay in New Zealand lawfully.

[Interim Visa \(https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/interim-visa/\)](https://immigration.govt.nz/visas/interim-visa/)

When we make a decision, we will email you.

If we approve your application, we will give you an eVisa and email you a copy.

[Using eVisas and visa labels](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/using-evisas-and-visa-labels/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/using-evisas-and-visa-labels/>)

Check the 'While you are in New Zealand' section to find out what you can and cannot do when you come to New Zealand.

How to pay and submit

We cannot display any process or costs information until you have provided your country details.
Enter your details so we can show information that is relevant to you.

Enter your details

When you get your visa

Your visa is valid from:

- the date you enter New Zealand, if you are outside New Zealand when we approve your application, or
- the date you get your visa, if you are already in New Zealand.

You must leave New Zealand before your visa expires.

When you arrive

Entry requirements

As part of New Zealand's entry requirements, everyone must complete a New Zealand Traveller Declaration (NZTD). This form collects information about your travel, including customs, immigration, and biosecurity details.

When you can submit your NZTD depends on how you're travelling:

- By air: You can submit it from 24 hours before your journey begins.
- By sea: You can submit it from 24 hours before your ship leaves its last overseas port heading to New Zealand.

If you have an NZeTA, you can specify in your declaration that you are applying for a visa on arrival.

A paper declaration form is available for travellers who cannot complete it online.

[New Zealand Traveller Declaration](#)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/https://www.travellerdeclaration.govt.nz/>)

New Zealand Customs and Biosecurity also check that you meet their entry requirements.

[Arriving in New Zealand](#)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/visit/what-you-need-to-visit-new-zealand/arriving-in-new-zealand/>)

Alert

You can be refused entry permission if you:

- do not meet our character requirements
- have had a change in circumstances since we approved your visa
- refuse to let us take your photo, fingerprints or an iris scan
- cannot provide evidence of any travel out of New Zealand or the money required to leave New Zealand.

Genuine intentions to visit or work in New Zealand

What might stop you from being allowed to enter New Zealand

While you are in New Zealand

Your visa conditions are recorded in your eVisa.

Travel

If you are travelling in and out of New Zealand, your visa must have a valid [multiple-entry travel condition](#) so you can return to New Zealand.

[Check or change your visa conditions](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/check-or-change-your-visa-conditions/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/check-or-change-your-visa-conditions/>)

The travel conditions are recorded in your eVisa.

Alert

If your visa does not have a multiple-entry travel condition and you leave New Zealand, your visa will expire.

Unless your visa states "Return/onward travel not required" you must have a ticket to leave New Zealand whenever you travel here.

Work

If you have a non-degree level 7 or lower qualification and your qualification is on the list of qualifications eligible for a Post Study Work Visa, you must work in a job that is related to what you studied — this will be listed in the conditions on your visa.

Qualifications needed for a Post Study Work Visa

If you have a degree level 7 or higher qualification, you can work in almost any job for any employer in New Zealand.

Note

You cannot provide commercial sexual services, or run or invest in a business that provides commercial sexual services.

Study

You can study for up to 3 months in any 12-month period.

Note

You may be able to do other study if it is required by your employer as part of your employment.

If you want to study longer than 3 months, you can apply for a variation of conditions to your work visa.

[Check or change your visa conditions](https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/check-or-change-your-visa-conditions/)

(<https://www.immigration.govt.nz/process-to-apply/once-you-have-a-visa/manage-your-visa-and-passport/check-or-change-your-visa-conditions/>)